

5 Works of scholars	5.1	Comparative study of ideas in the works of Shankara and Ramanuja: their respective contexts, key beliefs and influence (3) (4) a) Their respective contexts in the overall Vedanta traditions. b) Sources that influenced their beliefs. c) Key beliefs such as atman; Brahman with a range of meanings; samsara; moksha; dharma. d) Influence on Advaita Vedanta, including non-dualism and philosophical foundation to devotion of soul to the personal God; and on bhakti schools, including Chaitanya. e) Radical differences between Shankara and Ramanuja as seen in bhakti, which for Shankara is inferior given the knowledge of absolute unity, a clear commitment to monism; compared to Ramanuja's view that the soul becomes like God with no personal relationship with God. Claims regarding the Bhagavad Gita as supporting their own systems. f) The strengths and weaknesses of these beliefs for an understanding of Hinduism. With reference to the ideas of P Bowes and J Hopkins.
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